Taiwan ODMs

Rising downside risk to server supply and PC demand into 4Q26

Technology - Hardware

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Most Taiwan ODMs reported in-line or better-than-expected 3Q26 revenue, with divergence driven by customer mix and differences in project ramp schedules. We continue to see strong neocloud demand for GB300 and increasing adoption of the ODM-direct model. In contrast, we believe some CSPs are prioritizing resources toward VR200, given better TCO, and targeting larger-volume production in 1Q27. Overall, we see order spillover to second-tier ODMs, consistent with our view of improving ODM pricing dynamics. AWS Trainium 3 ("T3") server programs began ramping in 3Q26. Looking ahead, we expect a muted 4Q26 during the transition from air cooling to liquid cooling, despite robust underlying demand. For general servers, 3Q26 shipments remain strong across the supply chain, while 4Q26 may see some moderation due to component mismatches. For PCs, NB ODM builds fell 17% QoQ in 3Q26, and initial supply-chain feedback suggests another ~8% sequential decline in 4Q26. We see emerging risks for the PC supply chain following the pull-in of demand in 1H26. VGA/motherboard shipments also appear to be sub-seasonal in 2H26 due to price hikes and weak end demand. For iPhone EMS, 3Q26 revenue benefited from pull-ins of legacy models and the initial iPhone 18 ramp. However, we have become more cautious on 4Q26 amid mixed sell-through signals and potential order cuts. In the server ODM space, our preference order is **Wistron = Wiwynn > Quanta > Hon Hai > Pegatron > Inventec > Compal**. We like **ASPEED** for clear order visibility and improved substrate supply. We are OW on **Accton** given undemanding valuations and expect the stock to rebound after the 3Q earnings "clearing event." In the PC space, our pecking order is **Lenovo > ASUSTek > MSI**.

- **Nvidia GPU AI servers: Neocloud momentum supports 4Q amid CSP VR transition.** We estimate 18% QoQ growth in NVL72 rack shipments in 3Q26, driven mainly by resilient GB300 demand from both CSPs and neocloud customers. Looking into 4Q26, we expect continued strength from neocloud GB300 pull-in demand, supported by attractive token economics. While CSPs are prioritizing VR200 given better TCO, we believe VR rack shipments will remain limited in 4Q26 (approximately 7k racks in total) due to suboptimal yields, followed by a resumption of momentum in 1Q27. We expect ODMs with higher neocloud/enterprise AI exposure to see limited air pockets in 4Q26. In addition, as ODM capacity tightens, some orders appear to be spilling over to second-tier ODMs, consistent with our view of improving pricing terms in new ODM contracts going forward. Overall, **Wistron** is our top ODM pick, given potential margin upside amid improving pricing dynamics and continued new customer wins.
- **ASIC AI servers: AWS T3 transition in 4Q ahead of a meaningful liquid-cooled T3 rack ramp in 1H27.** We attribute the slight miss in Accton's September revenue to the increasing adoption of the consignment model. Management also cited a double-digit unit ramp in AWS module shipments in 3Q26. Looking into 4Q26, we see a delay in liquid-cooled T3 server shipments from September to December, which could weigh on liquid-cooling component vendors and certain system-level component suppliers (e.g., chassis and rail kits). At the system level, Wiwynn's management guided that AWS revenue accounted for over 50% of September revenue and expects continued revenue growth in 4Q26 despite market concerns around yields. We

See page 6 for analyst certification and important disclosures, including non-US analyst disclosures.

attribute the divergence across the AWS supply chain to differences in production cycle times, and see risks to Wiwynn's AWS revenue in late 4Q26 and 1Q27. Overall, we remain constructive on the AWS ASIC supply chain into 2027 despite potential near-term shipment volatility in 4Q26. Module vendors (e.g. **Accton**) and liquid-cooling vendors (e.g. **AVC**) should also benefit from higher content value over time.

- **General servers: 3Q shipment beats, but downside risks to 4Q forecasts are rising.** We saw 3Q general server shipments beat across the supply chain, driven by better-than-expected supply constraints and improved order fulfillment. Wiwynn's 3Q26 revenue beat implies ~20% QoQ general server shipment growth, based on our estimates. Looking into 4Q26, Wiwynn's management tone appears mixed given uncertainty around component supply. Quanta also indicated lower 2H26 general server shipments versus 1H26. We believe end demand for general servers remains solid, supported by strength in upstream server component revenues. However, we agree that downside risks are rising, particularly around component supply mismatches. Net-net, we forecast general server shipments to grow by only mid- to low-single digits QoQ in 4Q26. As server memory supply improves in 1H27, we maintain our 20–25% server system shipment growth estimates for 2027. The key downside risk is a potential inventory adjustment in upstream server components if this divergence persists for a prolonged period.
- **PCs: Weak demand persists into 4Q after the 3Q correction.** 3Q26 notebook ODM shipments declined 17% QoQ, in line with previously lowered guidance. The initial 4Q26 outlook indicates another 8% QoQ shipment decline, reflecting weak end demand following the 1H26 pull-in. We expect 2H26 notebook shipments to be down 27% YoY, versus a 5% YoY decline in 1H26. Weakening PC semiconductor sales in 3Q26 also support this view. It is also worth noting that our research suggests that selective PC brands have turned more cautious on 2H26/2027 PC end demand due to slower Windows activation rates. As notebook ASPs continue to rise in 3Q26, we believe PC brand margins could remain resilient in the near term. However, we see potential downside over the next six months due to sharper demand deterioration and negative operating leverage. Notably, ASUSTek posted resilient PC sales, with ~20% QoQ revenue growth and shipment growth in 3Q26, and guided to a flat 4Q PC shipment outlook (versus an industry outlook of ~20% QoQ decline). ASUSTek appeared relatively well-positioned than peers during the downturn, supported by market share gains.
- **VGA/Motherboard: Price hikes are pressuring demand.** ASUSTek posted better-than-expected 3Q26 components revenue, driven primarily by price hikes during the quarter. ASUSTek's VGA and motherboard shipments were broadly in line in 3Q26, with VGA shipments down by high-single digits QoQ and motherboard shipments up by low-single digits QoQ. Overall, we expect aggregate shipments for the top three motherboard/VGA vendors to be flat to down QoQ in 4Q26, and to decline by a mid-teens percentage YoY in 2026, as lackluster end demand persists amid elevated pricing. Our top avoid is **MSI**, as motherboard/VGA accounts for ~40–50% of the company's total revenue.
- **iPhone EMS: Pull-ins benefited 3Q, but lengthened 4Q lead time implies downside to 1Q27.** Both Pegatron and Hon Hai saw solid pull-in demand for iPhone 18 Pro and legacy models in 3Q26. Hon Hai's September iPhone revenue was flat YoY, reflecting fewer model shipments versus last year, while Pegatron posted a sharp MoM jump in September revenue, implying potential market share gains. Looking ahead, demand signals for iPhone 18 remain mixed amid price hikes. Our US research team indicates a sharper moderation in Pro lead times and we see potential order cuts. Based on commentary from Largan, we have turned more cautious on iPhone EMS demand into 1Q27 following the 4Q26 build.

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Table 1: September sales summary

NT$ bn	Sep '26 sales	MoM (%)	YoY (%)	JPMe 3Q26	3Q aggregate sales as % of JPMe	Consensus 3Q26	3Q aggregate sales as % of Consensus
PC Brands							
Asus	90.8	2%	15%	270.7	96%	283.2	91%
Acer	34.7	15%	18%	N.A.	N.A.	85.2	108%
MSI	19.9	13%	2%	55.0	104%	55.3	103%
Gigabyte	63.1	33%	125%	N.A.	N.A.	141.2	110%
Notebook ODMs							
Wistron	380.8	-17%	87%	1,162.8	99%	1,064.7	108%
Compal	94.4	40%	35%	248.8	98%	251.5	97%
Inventec	98.6	18%	63%	285.3	95%	255.5	106%
Quanta	325.3	-23%	77%	1,117.0	100%	1,107.2	101%
iPhone EMS							
Hon Hai	1,158.6	26%	38%	2,796.8	108%	2,835.3	107%
Pegatron	214.8	143%	87%	291.3	134%	303.5	128%
Server							
Wiwynn	172.6	20%	100%	398.7	109%	360.5	121%
ASPEED	1.6	1%	101%	4.6	104%	4.7	102%
Components							
Delta	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.	213.3	N.A.	208.1	N.A.
Liteon	18.8	-4%	22%	N.A.	N.A.	60.1	96%
Lotes	3.4	5%	16%	10.3	96%	10.2	97%
Networking							
Accton	40.4	-1%	66%	124.4	97%	118.6	102%
PC semis							
ELAN	0.6	-19%	-47%	N.A.	N.A.	3.1	73%

Source: Company data, Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan estimates.

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Table 2: NVL72 rack shipment estimates

NVL72 (unit)	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	Jul	Aug	Sep	3Q26E	4Q26E	2025	2026E	2027E
Hon Hai	400	1,500	4,200	5,800	6,526	7,253	3,059	2,900	2,950	8,900	8,150	11,900	30,829	36,995
Quanta	150	1,400	1,600	3,300	4,400	5,300	2,000	2,400	1,600	6,000	5,000	6,450	20,700	23,000
Wistron	150	1,800	1,350	2,500	3,879	4,050	1,250	2,350	1,400	5,000	5,500	5,800	18,429	22,115
Others	200	300	850	1,700	2,195	2,397				2,650	2,750	3,050	9,991	13,890
Total	900	5,000	8,000	13,300	17,000	19,000				22,550	21,400	27,200	79,950	96,000

Source: J.P. Morgan estimates, Company data.

Table 3: Taiwan ODM 4Q26 NB guidance

Companies	Ticker	4Q26
Wistron	3231 TT	15% QoQ decline in 4Q26
Compal	2324 TT	Flatt QoQ in 4Q26
Inventec	2356 TT	HSD QoQ decline in 4Q26
Quanta	2382 TT	QoQ decline in 4Q26
Pegatron	4938 TT	QoQ decline in 4Q26

Source: Company data.

Table 4: Quarterly notebook shipments by ODM

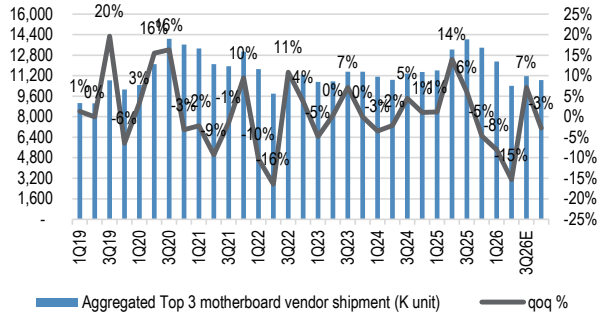
Qrtly shipments	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25	2Q25	3Q25	4Q25	1Q26	2Q26	3Q26E	4Q26E
Wistron (3231 TT)	4,600	5,100	5,200	5,300	4,900	5,900	6,400	6,900	6,100	5,500	4,500	3,825
Compal (2324 TT)	7,500	8,700	8,300	7,800	7,000	7,100	7,100	6,830	5,900	6,200	4,900	4,851
Inventec (2356 TT)	4,500	4,900	5,200	5,400	5,000	5,600	5,400	5,300	5,400	5,400	4,900	4,508
Quanta (2382 TT)	10,500	11,700	12,600	11,100	10,800	12,100	12,700	10,900	10,000	11,500	9,600	8,640
Pegatron (4938 TT)	1,585	2,040	2,500	1,950	1,885	2,375	2,400	2,410	1,800	1,750	1,285	1,259
Total (K units)	**28,685**	**32,440**	**33,800**	**31,550**	**29,585**	**33,075**	**34,000**	**32,340**	**29,200**	**30,350**	**25,185**	**23,083**
QoQ Growth	**1Q24**	**2Q24**	**3Q24**	**4Q24**	**1Q25**	**2Q25**	**3Q25**	**4Q25**	**1Q26**	**2Q26**	**3Q26E**	**4Q26E**
Wistron (3231 TT)	-13%	11%	2%	2%	-8%	20%	8%	8%	-12%	-10%	-18%	-15%
Compal (2324 TT)	-10%	16%	-5%	-6%	-10%	1%	0%	-4%	-14%	5%	-21%	-2%
Inventec (2356 TT)	0%	9%	6%	4%	-7%	12%	-4%	-2%	2%	0%	-9%	-8%
Quanta (2382 TT)	1%	11%	8%	-12%	-3%	12%	5%	-14%	-8%	15%	-17%	-10%
Pegatron (4938 TT)	-4%	29%	23%	-22%	-3%	26%	1%	0%	-25%	-3%	-27%	-2%
Total (m units)	**-5%**	**13%**	**4%**	**-7%**	**-6%**	**12%**	**3%**	**-5%**	**-10%**	**4%**	**-17%**	**-8%**
Y/Y Growth	**1Q24**	**2Q24**	**3Q24**	**4Q24**	**1Q25**	**2Q25**	**3Q25**	**4Q25**	**1Q26**	**2Q26**	**3Q26E**	**4Q26E**
Wistron (3231 TT)	18%	11%	0%	0%	7%	16%	23%	30%	24%	-7%	-30%	-45%
Compal (2324 TT)	-1%	0%	-11%	-6%	-7%	-18%	-14%	-12%	-16%	-13%	-31%	-29%
Inventec (2356 TT)	2%	0%	6%	20%	11%	14%	4%	-2%	8%	-4%	-9%	-15%
Quanta (2382 TT)	-3%	-7%	-4%	7%	3%	3%	1%	-2%	-7%	-5%	-24%	-21%
Pegatron (4938 TT)	-7%	-2%	0%	18%	19%	16%	-4%	24%	-5%	-26%	-46%	-48%
Total (m units)	**1%**	**-1%**	**-3%**	**5%**	**3%**	**2%**	**1%**	**3%**	**-1%**	**-8%**	**-26%**	**-29%**

Source: Company data, J.P. Morgan estimates.

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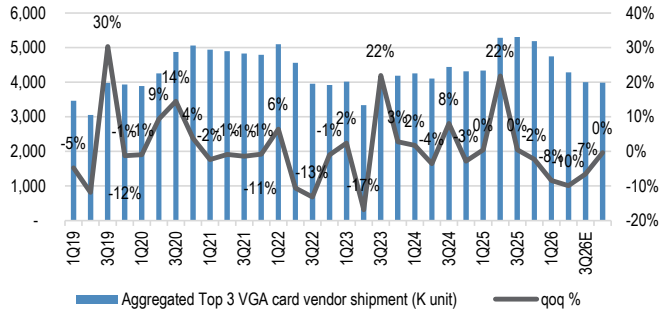
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Figure 1: Aggregated top 3 MB vendors' quarterly shipments and qoq trend



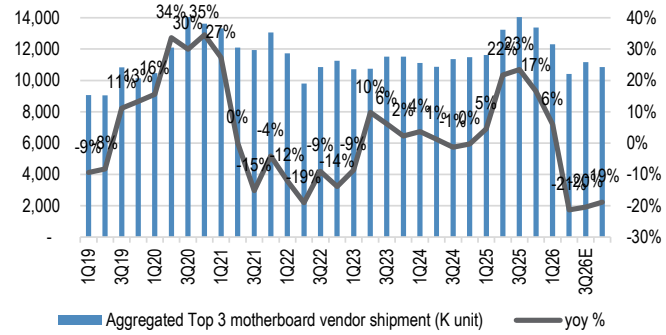
Source: Company data, J.P. Morgan estimates.

Figure 2: Aggregated top 3 VGA card vendors' quarterly shipments and qoq trend



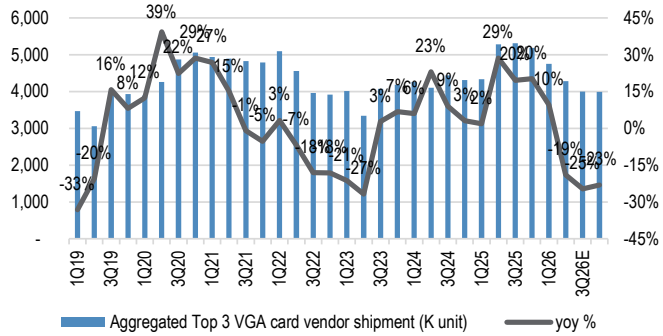
Source: Company data, J.P. Morgan estimates.

Figure 3: Aggregated top 3 MB vendors' quarterly shipments and yoy trend



Source: Company data. J.P. Morgan estimates.

Figure 4: Aggregated top 3 VGA card vendors' quarterly shipments and yoy trend



Source: Company data. J.P. Morgan estimates.

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ASPEED Technology Inc.(5274.TWO/NT$17,485.00/OW), ASUSTek Computer(2357.TW/NT$996.00/N), Accton(2345.TW/NT $2,070.00/OW), Asia Vital Components(3017.TW/NT$3,440.00/OW), Compal Electronics, Inc.(2324.TW/NT$35.50/N), Delta Electronics, Inc.(2308.TW/NT$1,965.00/OW), Hon Hai Precision(2317.TW/NT$249.00/OW), Inventec(2356.TW/NT$57.50/N), Largan Precision Co Ltd(3008.TW/NT$6,660.00/OW), Lenovo Group Limited (0992)(0992.HK/HK$32.84[09 October 2026]/ OW), Lotes(3533.TW/NT$1,915.00/OW), Micro-Star International Co., Ltd.(2377.TW/NT$154.50/N), Pegatron Corp(4938.TW/ NT$89.70/N), Quanta Computer Inc.(2382.TW/NT$325.50/OW), Wistron Corporation(3231.TW/NT$188.50/OW), Wiwynn Corp(6669.TW/NT$2,240.00/OW)

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Completed 11 Oct 2026 05:44 PM HKT

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